

Airport pickup

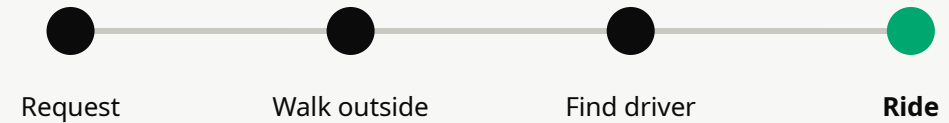
**The ride has already been booked.
The anxiety starts when the rider has
to find the car.**

A normal pickup uses a simple handoff. Airports force a traveler to translate an app pin into a physical, regulated route while tired, carrying bags, and time constrained.

PRODUCT INSIGHT

**The failure happens after matching.
Uber has a driver and a rider, but no shared
plan for meeting.**

NORMAL PICKUP



AIRPORT PICKUP



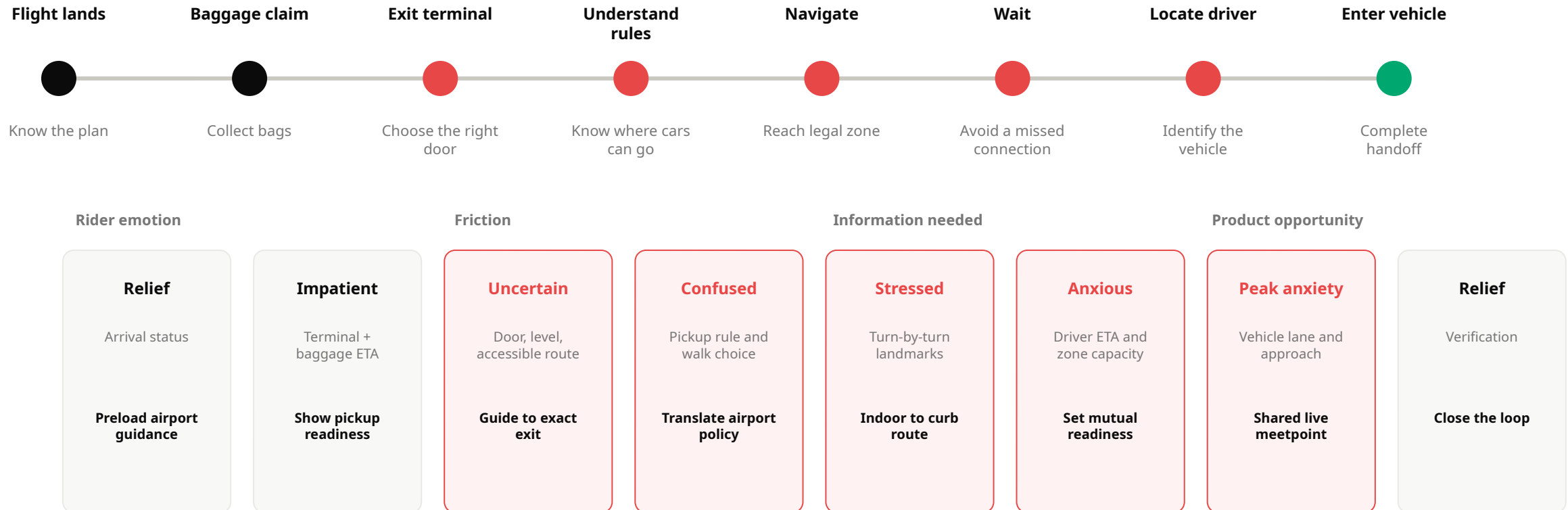
**High cognitive load starts at the terminal exit, where
the app becomes a poor proxy for the airport.**

Design question

**How can Uber turn a moving airport
into one clear meeting instruction?**

Airport pickup journey

The emotion curve rises where location context breaks. Product opportunities should appear before the rider needs to ask.



Highest anxiety

The rider lacks a confident answer to “Where am I going, and will my driver be there?”

The shared-location problem

A digital pickup pin often collapses a multi-level, multi-door airport into a single coordinate.

What the app sees

Pickup pin

One coordinate
One ETA
One meeting assumption

What the rider experiences

Terminal 2

arrivals level

Door 4

Parking / skybridge

Level 3

elevator

Rideshare island

Zone B

curb lane

Coordina
tion
gap

GPS cannot state
which door, level,
or curb lane.

The same “point” can require three different routes.

Root cause

Uber matches two moving people to a place that neither side can interpret the same way.

Uber Meetpoint

A shared live plan from terminal exit to vehicle handoff.

Product concept

One canonical meeting state:

“Terminal 2, Door 4, Zone B. Rider arrives in 90 seconds. Driver joins after confirmation.”

RIDER GUIDANCE

Walking route

Terminal context, doorway, accessibility route and walking ETA.

UBER MEETPOINT

Shared state

One zone assignment, readiness signal and exception policy.

DRIVER ROUTING

Curb arrival

Legal route, staging guidance, rider ETA and wait threshold.

AIRPORT CONTROLS

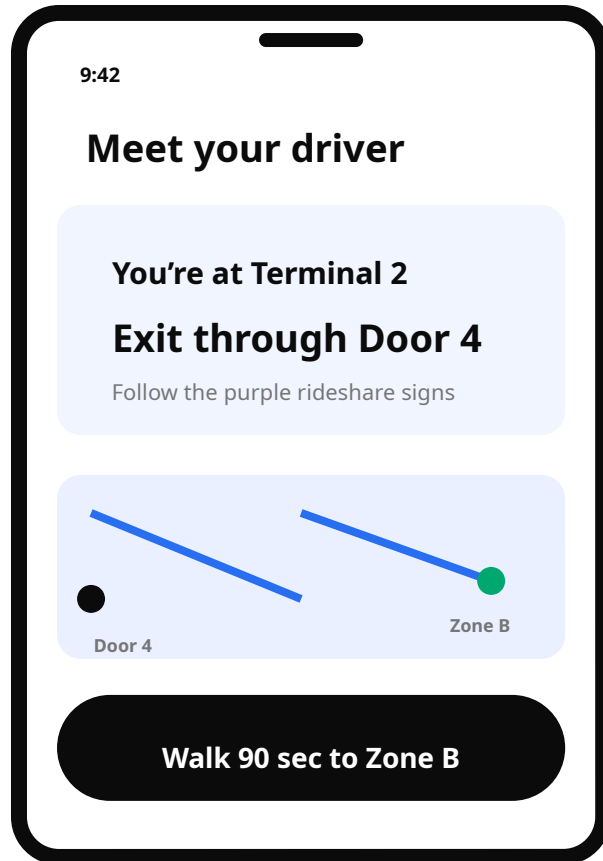
Rules engine

Zone availability, closures, restrictions and local configuration.

The feature owns the handoff, not the entire airport map.

Rider experience

Guidance behaves like a calm airport companion, with a single next action and clear recovery paths.



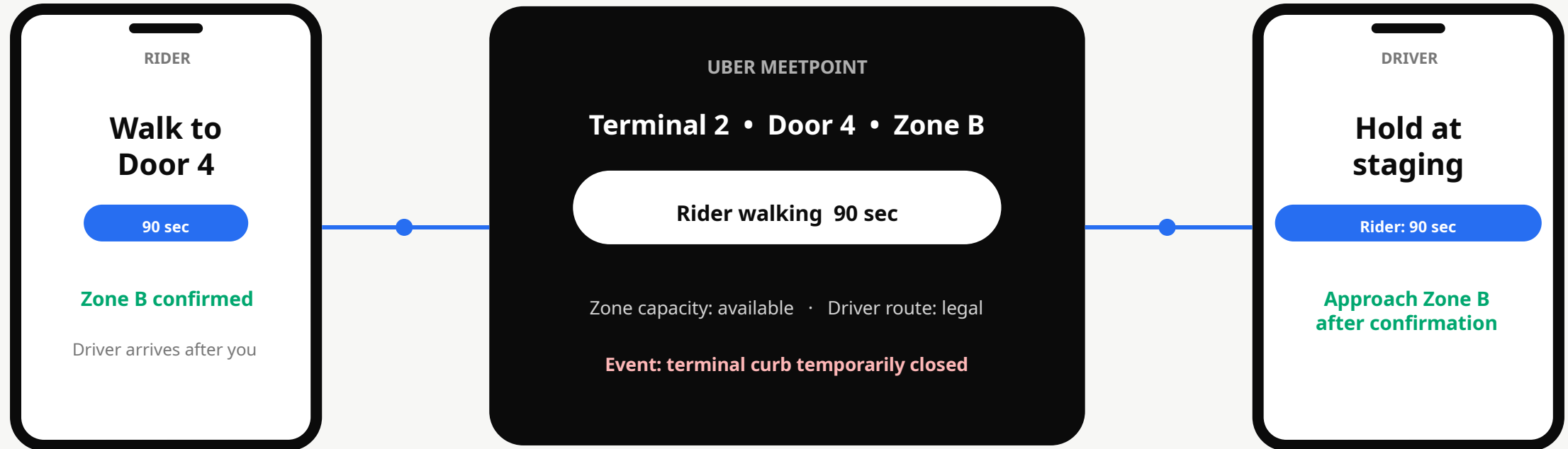
What changes for the rider

- Context before action**
The app recognizes terminal and arrival stage before asking the rider to navigate.
- Landmarks over coordinates**
Door, level and airport signage answer the question a blue dot cannot.
- Mutual readiness**
The rider sees when to walk. The driver sees when to approach.
- Graceful exceptions**
"I'm at a different door," mobility needs, lost signal and zone closure get specific recovery actions.

Priority: reduce the number of decisions the rider must make after baggage claim.

Driver and rider coordination

Both sides see the same source of truth, timed to their next decision.

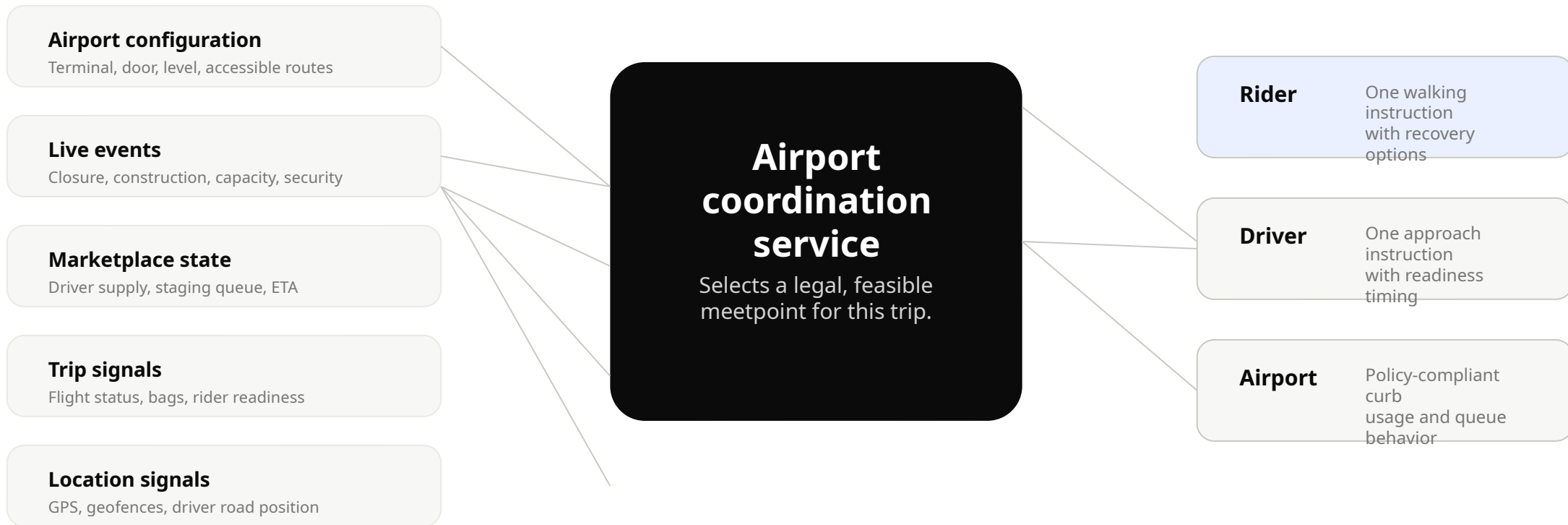


No “where are you?” loop

The system removes ambiguous language by making readiness, place and approach order explicit.

Operational complexity

The product absorbs local infrastructure, changing rules and marketplace conditions before they reach the rider.



Scale model

Tier 1: structured airport map / Tier 2: live zone events / Tier 3: airport partner integrations

Activation and success metrics

Measure the handoff, not app engagement. Targets below are illustrative hypotheses.

NORTH STAR • PROPOSED

Coordinated Pickup Success Rate

Completed airport trips that reach vehicle entry within the expected window without cancellation, reassignment or rider-driver contact.

Pickup reliability

Meetpoint confirmation rate
Vehicle entry within expected time
Cancellation after match

Rider confidence

"I knew where to go"
Support contacts during pickup
Route recovery rate

Driver efficiency

Wait time at curb
Unproductive approach loops
Driver cancellation after arrival

Operational health

Zone overflow
Rule compliance exceptions
Airport-specific incident rate

Illustrative pilot thresholds

+3 pp Coordinated Pickup Success • -10% airport support contacts • no increase in curb dwell time

MVP and experimentation

Start with structured guidance at airports where policy is clear, then earn the right to add real-time optimization.

MVP

Airport configuration for selected terminals
Terminal and door guidance
Rider “ready to walk” signal
Driver sees rider walking ETA

V2

Dynamic zone assignment
Shared driver-rider Meetpoint state
Closure and reroute events
Accessible-route preferences

Not in MVP

Indoor AR, universal airport mapping and a rider-driver chatbot add cost before validating the coordination loop.

Future

Airport partner feeds
Zone capacity optimization
Arrival prediction from trip signals
On-ground assistance handoff

Experiments

Door guidance

Hypothesis: Fewer rider-driver messages

Measure: Contact rate / trip completion

Readiness timing

Hypothesis: Drivers approach after riders arrive

Measure: Curb dwell / wait time

Landmark language

Hypothesis: More confident route following

Measure: Route recovery / rider confidence

The PM point of view

Airport pickup needs a shared plan, not a better pin.

A rider needs certainty about where to walk. A driver needs certainty about when and where to approach. The airport needs both to follow its constraints.

Rider confidence

Knows the next physical action

Driver efficiency

Avoids premature approaches and loops

Pickup reliability

More matches convert to vehicle entry

Marketplace health

Fewer cancellations and support interventions

Product thesis

Uber can make airport pickup feel dependable by owning the coordination between people, place and policy.

Proposal by Anamika Nayak · Product Management Case Study